

A clearer brief. A better first conversation.

A practical checklist for your next app, website, software or AI project. You do not need every answer before you speak with a partner; use this to organise what you know and what you still need to work out.

01 THE PROBLEM

- ☐ What problem or opportunity are you trying to address?
- ☐ Who experiences it, and how do they handle it today?
- ☐ What makes this important now?

02 THE PEOPLE

- ☐ Who are the main users or teams involved?
- ☐ What are the most important tasks they need to complete?
- ☐ Are there accessibility or language needs to consider?

03 THE OUTCOME

- ☐ What should become easier, faster, clearer or more reliable?
- ☐ How will you recognise that the first release is useful?
- ☐ What should the product never compromise?

04 FIRST RELEASE

- ☐ Which three capabilities are essential on day one?
- ☐ What can wait for a later phase?
- ☐ What is explicitly outside the first release?

05 SYSTEMS & DATA

- ☐ Which existing tools, platforms or data sources are involved?
- ☐ Which integrations, roles or approval steps are needed?
- ☐ Are there security, privacy or compliance requirements?

06 AI, IF RELEVANT

- ☐ What task could AI help with, and what information would it use?
- ☐ How should a person review or correct the result?
- ☐ Could a simpler workflow or automation solve the need?

07 DELIVERY

- ☐ Is there a target date or event to work towards?
- ☐ Who will make decisions and provide feedback?
- ☐ What budget range or constraints should shape the plan?

08 THE NEXT STEP

- ☐ What would you like an experienced partner to help decide?
- ☐ What existing brief, design or system can you share?
- ☐ Who else should be part of the first conversation?

Your notes
